

PRD Pack Business Evaluation Research Plan

Date: 2026-07-03

Status: plan complete, research not executed

Scope: Product Discovery-to-Production PRD Pack as service, productized service, and future product

Executive Decision

The next business-plan report should evaluate ArchFlow as a service first, productized service second, and software product third. Current evidence proves the internal method and the provider-disabled operating surface; it does not yet prove demand, willingness to pay, or a repeatable cloud product.

The research plan therefore asks one main question: can the PRD Pack become a paid wedge for B2B SaaS product teams, and which delivery model should be tested first?

Current Evidence Baseline

Layer	Evidence	Status	Business meaning
Method	E1.2 and E1.2.8 convert approved material into PRD, backlog, questions, review packet	Proven locally	Service delivery can be demonstrated
KB	E1.4 defines memory promotion, traceback, provenance, and dashboard-packet gates	Accepted	Repeatability has governance
Research	E2.0A defines source boundary, evidence cards, and grading	Accepted	Market research can start without overclaiming
Dashboard/Jarvis	Vercel review-packet API is provider-disabled and verified in prior run notes	Proven for static/review scope	Useful operator cockpit, not full SaaS runtime
Railway	Service scaffold exists; deployment and health proof remain gated	Planned	Needed for full cloud product/runtime
Demand	No outreach, paid diagnostic, prepayment, or firm paid intent exists	Not proven	Must not be claimed

Research Lenses

Lens	Question	Method	Output
Buyer	Who feels PRD/research handoff pain strongly enough to engage?	Public job/review/company signal scan, later interviews	Buyer map and pain hypotheses
Service	Can ArchFlow deliver a useful done-for-you PRD Pack with current setup?	Internal proof review, delivery blueprint, effort estimate	Service delivery model
Productized service	Can the method be packaged into fixed inputs, timeline, outputs, and review gates?	Scope/pricing test, artifact checklist, QA model	Offer package
Product	What must be automated before cloud SaaS is honest?	Runtime gap map, Railway/Jarvis readiness, security review	Productization roadmap
Market	What alternatives already solve parts of this?	Competitor matrix and review-mining plan	Differentiation map
Finance	What pricing and unit economics are plausible?	Bottom-up delivery effort, buyer budget proxy, ROI model	Pricing hypotheses

Lens	Question	Method	Output
Risk	Where can claims overreach?	AF Review against evidence rubric	Red/yellow/green risk table

Target Audience Hypotheses

Primary ICP remains B2B SaaS product teams, Series B-D, 50-500 employees, 2-5 PMs, with Director or VP Product accountable for PRD quality and speed.

Audience	Current confidence	What to prove
Director/VP Product in B2B SaaS	Medium as ICP hypothesis	Two independent public signals per target showing PRD, discovery, handoff, or team-scaling pain
Product Ops lead	Low-medium	Whether budget/ownership sits in Product Ops at larger accounts
Founder-led B2B startup	Later lane	Whether lack of PM team makes the offer simpler or too early
AI/product-service agency	Later lane	Whether this is an enablement product rather than first buyer
Enterprise product org	Later lane	Security/procurement barriers before value proof

Delivery-Model Evaluation

Model	Best use now	Strength	Weakness	Gate before selling
Done-for-you service	First market test	Can use Codex/operator method now	Manual labor, founder delivery dependency	One clean sample, scope boundary, price, owner-approved outreach
Productized service	First paid offer candidate	Fixed artifact bundle and review gates	Needs clear intake and turnaround SLA	E2 evidence, E3 page, E5 ROI logic
Cloud product	Future	Scalable and dashboard-led	Needs Railway/backend/auth/secrets/provider policy/writeback	E1.7 Railway health, auth, CORS, budget guard, security review
Internal operating system	Current	Improves ArchFlow execution quality	Not directly buyer-facing	Keep as proof engine and demo material

Research Phases

Phase	Work	Sources	Agents	Stop rule
1. Baseline	Summarize current setup and proof	project/reports/, project/runs/, wiki/	AF Context, AF Review	No demand claims
2. Market map	Compare categories and competitors	Public websites, pricing pages, review summaries	AF Research	No scraped private data
3. Audience map	Build account/role hypotheses	Public directories, careers pages, authorized LinkedIn summaries	AF Tools, AF Research	No personal lead data in public repo
4. Offer model	Compare service/productized/product economics	Internal delivery artifacts, public pricing proxies	AF Manager	Pricing remains HYPOTHESIS
5. Risk review	Test claims, privacy, source boundary, productization	E1.4 principle, E2.0A rubric	AF Review	Unsupported claims downgraded
6. Business-plan report	Produce recommendation and next test	Reviewed evidence only	Codex integrator	Owner review before outreach

Competitor And Alternative Set

Use local competitor notes first, then public sources. Initial comparison set:

- Productboard, Aha!, Dovetail, Zeda, BuildBetter, Fibery, Cycle, ChatPRD, Notion AI, Glean, Dust.

Comparison columns:

Column	Reason
Outcome sold	Avoid comparing only feature lists
Artifact promised	Match against PRD Pack outputs
Evidence/review model	Identify trust gap
Integrations	Understand buyer switching cost
AI claim	Separate real workflow from AI copy
CTA/pricing	Estimate buying motion
Privacy boundary	Check whether ArchFlow can win on safety
ArchFlow gap/opportunity	Produce positioning, not generic analysis

Business Metrics To Estimate

Metric	Source	Status
Delivery hours per PRD Pack	Internal E1/E1.2.8 activity reports	Estimate only
Buyer time saved	Interview/outreach later; internal model now	HYPOTHESIS
PRD rework avoided	Public pain evidence and later pilots	HYPOTHESIS
Price range	Competitor/service pricing proxies and buyer budget signals	HYPOTHESIS
Gross margin	Delivery effort and tool cost	HYPOTHESIS
Demand	E6/E7 paid or firm-intent proof	GAP

Acceptance Criteria For The Deep Research

- Uses only approved sources or sanitized summaries.
- Separates FACT, INTERPRETATION, HYPOTHESIS, and GAP.
- Recommends first delivery model without claiming demand.
- Includes competitor matrix, audience map, pricing hypotheses, risk table, and execution roadmap.
- Produces a Notion-ready summary, PDF, Git commit, and Telegram packet after review.
- Leaves owner questions for E2 before real account research starts.

Review, Push, Notion, Telegram Plan

- AF Review checks evidence quality, public safety, and overclaim risk.
- Run validation: public safety scan, dashboard regeneration and JSON parse, `git diff --check`.
- Stage and push only public-safe reports, run notes, dashboard data, and status packets.
- Add an append-only Notion update to the relevant Epic 1/Epic 2 pages after push, linking the GitHub report/PDF paths.
- Send the report PDFs to Telegram through the approved sender script. If blocked, store sanitized blocked status and exact retry command.